



EDUCATION

- **Tulane University** — Ph.D. Candidate in **Economics** New Orleans, LA.
Specializations: Applied Microeconomics, Health Economics, Innovation
- **Tulane University** — Master in **Economics** New Orleans, LA.
Specializations: Applied Microeconomics
- **Tehran Polytechnic** — Master of Science in **Business Administration** Tehran
Graduated Top 3 in Class
- **University of Isfahan** — Bachelor of Science in **Mechanical Engineering** Isfahan
Achieved a Top 1% Ranking in the National University Entrance Exam

FIELDS

Public Economics, Health Economics, Labor Economics, Innovation

WORKING PAPERS

- **The Children of Welfare Reform: Early Childhood Under the New Rules and Adult Outcomes** *Job Market Paper*
 - **Abstract:** Welfare reform in the 1990s replaced Aid to Families with Dependent Children (AFDC), a cash entitlement for poor families, with Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF), aid conditioned on work and limited to a fixed number of months. Those rules raised parents' employment but cut cash income and the time parents had with their children, so whether the young children in those families gained or lost is an open question. This paper follows those children into adulthood and asks whether more time under stricter rules in early childhood changed their general health, mental health and employment outcomes. Because the rules differed across states, this paper scores each state's rules year by year, from 0 under the AFDC rules to 1 at the strictest setting any state used. A child's strictness-adjusted years of exposure are the months from conception to age five spent under reform, weighted by the state's score. Those years should matter most where the family was likely to receive welfare. The paper therefore compares children of the same birth state and cohort whose families had higher and lower predicted probabilities of welfare receipt. The comparison is made in the Panel Study of Income Dynamics for children born between 1975 and 1999. Each strictness-adjusted year of exposure is associated with a 0.05 standard deviation higher general health index (self-rated health and obesity) and a 0.07 standard deviation higher mental health index (psychological distress and psychiatric diagnosis) when a child whose family was likely to be on welfare is compared with one whose family was not. Both estimates are significant at the 10 percent level. Estimates that count the months under reform without scoring their strictness are smaller, so part of the effect comes from what the rules required and not only from how long they applied. The same exposure is not associated with a change in the children's employment. The estimates for their hours and earnings are imprecise. Taken together, these results suggest that stricter rules in early childhood left the children the reform reached healthier than their peers on both health indices.
- **Shocks, Reallocation, and the Direction of Innovation: The Case of COVID-19** *Working Paper*
 - Methods: BioBERT neural language model classifying four million PubMed papers (2018–2022) into research fields; interrupted time series; field-by-quarter panel regressions
 - Finding: The COVID-19 shock broke every field's share of biomedical attention, with no movement toward pandemic-adjacent fields; the adjustment ran within fields, as researchers folded coronavirus questions into existing work.
- **SNAP Generosity and Mental Health** *Working Paper*
 - Methods: Difference-in-Differences; dose-response Difference-in-Differences; XGBoost machine learning for data imputation
 - Finding: SNAP allotments support mental health during economic hardship, with effects emerging beyond a minimum benefit threshold.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Research & Teaching Assistant, Tulane University** *2021-present*
 - Courses: Econometrics II (Ph.D. Level); Machine Learning and Econometrics; Intermediate Microeconomics; Health Economics; Introduction to Macroeconomics; Introduction to Microeconomics.
- **Teaching Assistant — Strategic Management, Tehran Polytechnic** *Spring 2018*
 - Course: Strategic Management.

AWARDS

- APPAM Excellence, Equity and Inclusion Student Fellowship *2026–2027*
- Cato University Summer Term II (Full Scholarship), Cato Institute *August 2026*
- J.E. Land Fund for School of Liberal Arts Graduate Student Travel *July 2026*
- Graduate Student Summer Research Award, Tulane University *June 2024, May 2025*
- Graduate Studies Student Association Travel Award, Tulane University *May 2024*
- Joachim-Herz Foundation Award *June 2024*
- Connolly Alexander Institute for Data Science Research Grant Award *June 2024, April 2025*

CONFERENCE AND PRESENTATION

- **First Author Presenter**
 - Southern Economic Association (SEA) | Houston, TX. *November 2026*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Boston, MA. *November 2026*
 - American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) | Minneapolis, MN. *June 2026*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Seattle, WA. *Fall 2025*
 - Southern Economic Association (SEA) | Tampa, FL. *Fall 2025*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Washington, D.C. *Fall 2024*
 - Essen Economics of Mental Health, CINCH - Health Economics Research Center | Universität Duisburg-Essen. Held at the University of Minnesota, Minneapolis, MN. *August 2024*
 - American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) | San Diego, CA. *June 2024*

PEER REVIEW SERVICE

- **Discussant**
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Seattle, WA. *November 2025*
 - Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) | Boston, MA. *November 2026*

WORKING EXPERIENCE

- **Graduate Assistant Data Intern, AEO, Tulane University:** *August 2026-present*
 - Work with the Office of Academic Excellence and Opportunity on data collection, distribution, and assessment projects.
- **Statistical Research Consultant, CAIDS, Tulane University:** *August 2026-present*
 - Consult with Tulane faculty, staff, and student researchers at the Connolly Alexander Institute for Data Science on statistical methodology, research design, and analysis, with support in Python, R, and Stata.
- **Leadership Role at Tulane University:** *2022-2024*
 - Vice President, Graduate Student Association—led cross-council initiatives; managed budgets; university liaison.
- **Negin Bazr Co.** *2018-2021*
 - Product Marketing Manager, Market Researcher.
 - Developed and demonstrated advanced teamwork, decision-making, critical thinking, and problem-solving skills within the private sector, contributing to successful project outcomes and driving organizational efficiency.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Causal Inference:** Difference-in-Differences; Regression Discontinuity; Matching; Instrumental Variables
- **Quantitative Methods:** Econometric Modeling; Predictive Analytics; Deep Learning; Data Analysis
- **Deep Learning / NLP:** Neural Networks; BERT models; TF-IDF; Clustering; Classification
- **Programming:** Python; Stata; SQL
- **Computing:** Amazon Web Services (AWS); Tulane University High-Performance Computing (Cypress)
- **Languages:** English; Farsi

REFERENCES

1- Kevin Callison Associate Professor (Dissertation Chair) Department of Health Policy and Management Tulane University Email: kcallison@tulane.edu Phone: (614) 989-1764	2- Katy Bergstrom Assistant Professor Department of Economics Tulane University Email: kbergstrom@tulane.edu	3- Jonathan Holmes Assistant Professor Department of Economics Tulane University Email: jholmes13@tulane.edu
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